GinCol Lab · Aula

Student worksheet

Musical Language and Practice · 1st year of Bachillerato · A song, layer by layer · Class 2 of 8 · With Malik

Pulse and rhythm

Class video: https://youtu.be/BadBCFtMuYY

The code leads to the video.

Name: _____ Date: _____

Before you start

1. You need paper and a pencil, and room to clap. If you can, watch the class with headphones. You don't need any instrument.

2. Draw two grids of sixteen boxes in three rows (hi-hat, snare and kick drum), in four groups of four: one for the dictation and another for exercise 2. There is one to cut out at the end of this sheet.

While you watch the video

1. **The drum kit.** Which three pieces make up the rhythm layer? Which one is played with a pedal and gives the lowest hit? Which one has wire springs underneath?

2. **Pulse and rhythm.** How many pulses per minute does the channel's song have? How many each second? What is the difference between pulse and rhythm?

3. **The bar.** On which number does the chord change? What is a bar? And a beat? In a bar of four, which is the strong beat, which are weak and which is medium-strong?

4. **4/4.** What does the top number say? And the bottom one? Why does four mean the quarter note?

5. **Duple, triple and quadruple.** What changes from one to another? Give an example of music that goes in two and another that goes in three.

6. **The grid.** How long does a quarter note last? And an eighth note? And a sixteenth note? Into how many steps is each pulse divided on the grid? Which machine made this grid popular, and in what year did it come out?

7. **Drum notation.** What do its lines mark? Where does the hi-hat go? And the kick drum? And the snare?

8. **The snare.** Which of the two versions made your body move more: the snare on 1 and 3, or on 2 and 4? What is the snare on 2 and 4 called?

9. **The typical mistake.** Why is the strong beat not the hit that sounds loudest?

10. **How do we know?** How many of the 712 rock and roll records that Tamlyn studied have the snare on 2 and 4? Who invented it?

11. **The two halves.** Which half of each pulse is the strong one and which the weak one? How are they counted out loud?

12. **Offbeat and syncopation.** Which kick-drum hit comes early in the song? When is a hit an offbeat? What is a syncopation? How are they alike and how are they different?

13. **You keep the pulse.** Without the hi-hat, what sounds on beat three? Where did your clap fall?

14. **What moves you.** What do the studies on groove say about syncopated rhythms?

15. **The ostinato.** What is it? What does the word mean?

Strong or weak? Offbeat, syncopation or neither?

Write **S** if the note starts on a strong half (on the number) and **W** if it starts on a weak one (between two numbers). Then say whether it is an **offbeat**, a **syncopation** or **neither**.

1. The song's snare, on 2.

2. The song's first kick-drum hit, on 1.

3. The kick-drum hit that comes early, between 2 and 3.

4. The melody's long E, which starts between 2 and 3 and sounds over 3.

5. The long D in the fourth bar of the melody, which starts on 1.

Your turn, with your body

Instrument	With which part of the body	In which boxes
Kick drum		
Snare		
Hi-hat		

Careful: if you play the thigh and the clap by yourself, on 2 and on 4 the thigh hand goes up to the clap.

Dictation

Write on your grid where the kick drum sounds. The hi-hat and the snare go as in the song. Then mark whether any kick-drum hit is an offbeat.

Practice

1. In a song you like, count its pulses for 15 seconds, work out how many it has per minute and write down which layer marks them most clearly for you.

2. Write in a sixteen-step grid, and then in a score, a rhythm with the kick drum on 1 and 3, the snare on 2 and 4, and the hi-hat on the eight eighth notes.

3. Explain in your own words why the strong beat is not the hit that sounds loudest.

Keep thinking

Where is the groove: in exact timing or in the drummer's small deviations?

Grid to cut out

	1				2				3				4			
Hi-hat																
Snare																
Kick drum																

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